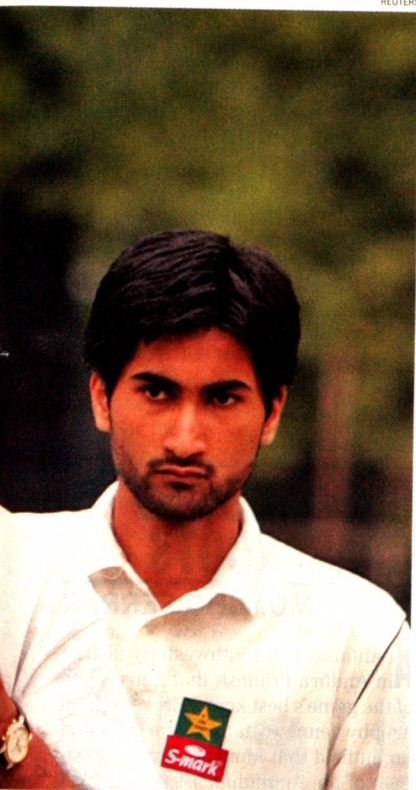




CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

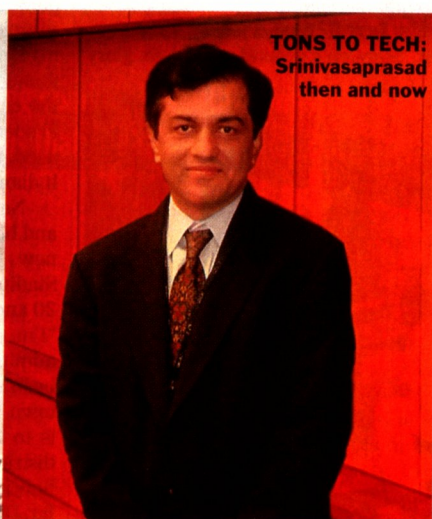
M.R. SRINIVASAPRASAD

MR. Srinivasaprasad, 48, would be astonished to find himself on this list but there could be fewer more qualified for the role of Indian cricket's first CEO. Vice-president with Fidelity Business Systems in Bangalore, he manages insurance technology groups in three cities. An engineer-MBA who has lived in Paris and Japan, he worked for ITI, Alcatel and set up Sony Technology Centre (which developed technology for products like Playstation 3).

But 20 years ago, he was one of Karnataka's distinguished first-class batsmen, his career spanning nine seasons. He still follows India, watches a Bangalore ODI when he can and misses the "sheer joy of playing hard". Asked about his impressions of Indian cricket (ignorant of this list), he replied, "Running Indian cricket is like running a billion-dollar company. Having a CEO is great but it would be important to get the right person and create the right environment for him to succeed."

The CEO, he said, would need to define end-goals and a time-frame, learn from successful examples and hire the right people. "The sport's environment has changed, Indian cricket needs to recognise this and change themselves to be successful."

His old coach John Wright, with whom Srinath had many a wrangle, says, "Sri would be a great choice to look after young fast bowlers wanting to play for India, where the drop-off rate is very high. He knows his stuff, has empathy and is forthright and honest."



TONS TO TECH:
Srinivasaprasad
then and now

THE SEEKER: Amre's eye for talent is respected



JUNIOR DEVELOPMENT

PRAVIN AMRE

Usually the junior selection committee acts as a parking lot for those who the BCCI wishes to bless with favours or quietly induct into its hierarchy. Thanks to the Board's zonal handouts, all kinds of candidates are lodged in the junior panel—the influential, the unsuitable and the unscrupulous. Doing a job, which, as chairman of the selection committee Dilip Vengsarkar admits, is tougher than what his colleagues on the senior panel must do.

Junior selection is grunt work, unglamorous labour undertaken in the hope that there are diamonds waiting to be found in the dust of some far-away town. The junior selector, if he is diligent, must travel to distant places, where comforts are few, identify players of skill as well as mental toughness, and then shepherd them up the ladder. Pravin Amre took to junior selection as chairman as if he was being given the keys to the kingdom of heaven.

A former India batsman and chairman of the junior selection committee, Amre formed a fruitful partnership with Vengsarkar when he was chairman of the BCCI's Talent Resource Development Wing (TRDW) created in 2002. The